

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete King's Gambit

Accepted and declined systems, tactical control, and conversion

TRAINING WORKBOOK

50 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

Workbook Method

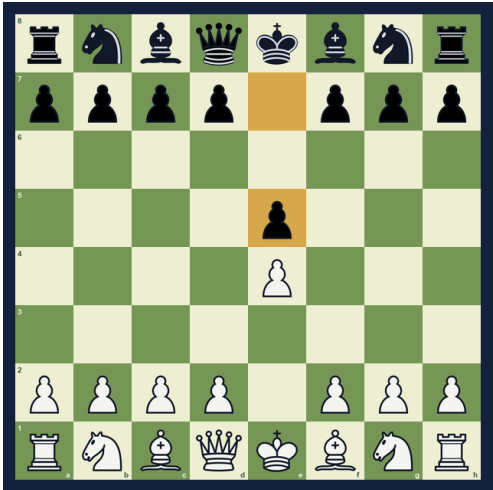
Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

01. King's Gambit Accepted Core - Stage 1



GAMBIT FOUNDATION

POSITION PROMPT

The starting position offers White a choice between quiet equality and immediate imbalance.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

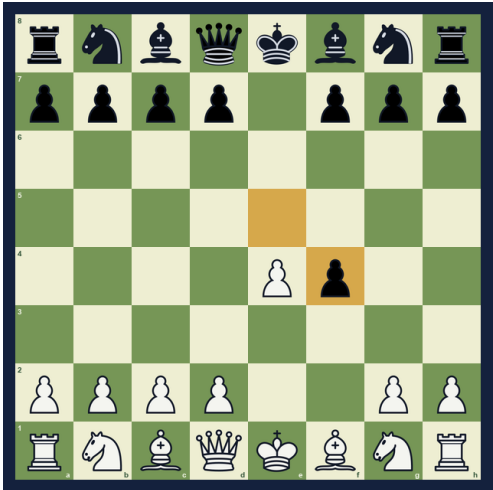
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

02. King's Gambit Accepted Core - Stage 2



GAMBIT FOUNDATION

POSITION PROMPT

Black has accepted the f-pawn and gained material while loosening control of the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

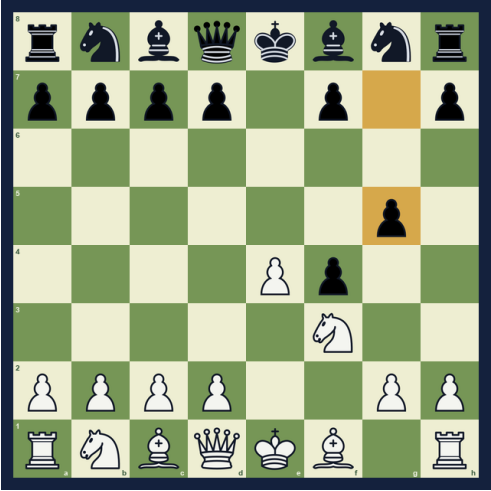
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

03. King's Gambit Accepted Core - Stage 3



GAMBIT FOUNDATION

POSITION PROMPT

White has developed with tempo against e5 while Black tries to protect the extra pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

04. King's Gambit Accepted Core - Stage 4



GAMBIT FOUNDATION

POSITION PROMPT

The g-pawn has advanced and attacked the f3-knight, creating the main tactical question.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

05. King's Gambit Accepted Core - Stage 5



GAMBIT FOUNDATION

POSITION PROMPT

The knight has reached e5 in the Kieseritzky structure, trading material security for activity.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4 5. Ne5 Nf6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

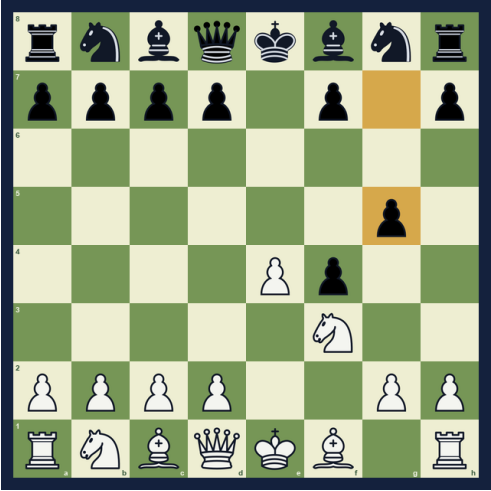
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

06. Kieseritzky Main Battle - Stage 1



KGA KIESERITZKY

POSITION PROMPT

Black's ...g5 defense has created a concrete pawn chain around the extra f4 pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

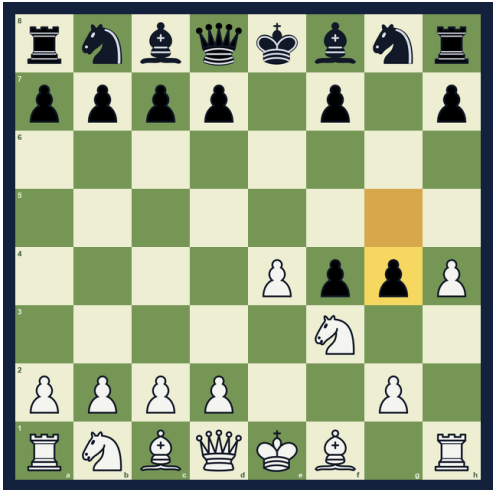
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

07. Kieseritzky Main Battle - Stage 2



KGA KIESERITZKY

POSITION PROMPT

White has challenged the chain with h4 and Black has driven the knight with ...g4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

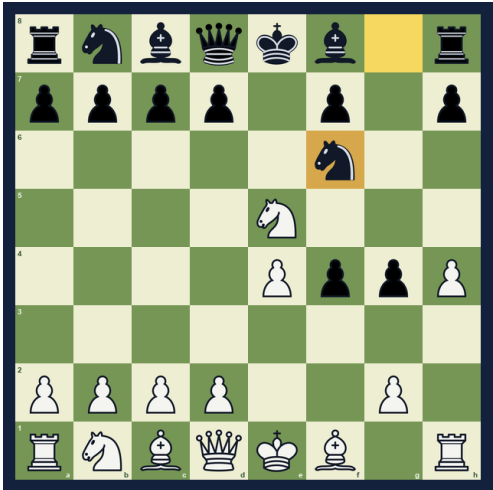
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

08. Kieseritzky Main Battle - Stage 3



KGA KIESERITZKY

POSITION PROMPT

Ne5 centralizes the knight and attacks key squares instead of retreating passively.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4 5. Ne5 Nf6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

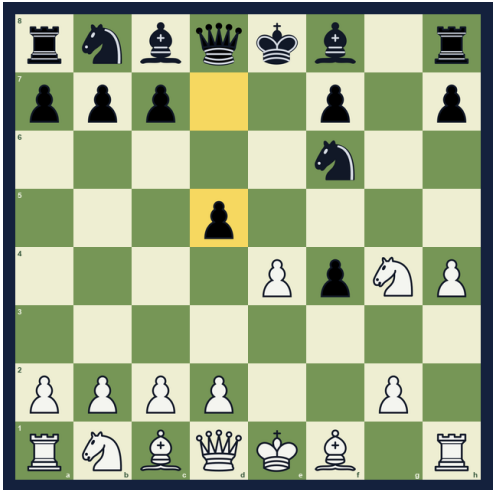
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

09. Kieseritzky Main Battle - Stage 4



KGA KIESERITZKY

POSITION PROMPT

White has removed the g4 pawn, while Black counters immediately with ...d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4 5. Ne5 Nf6 6. Nxc4 d5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

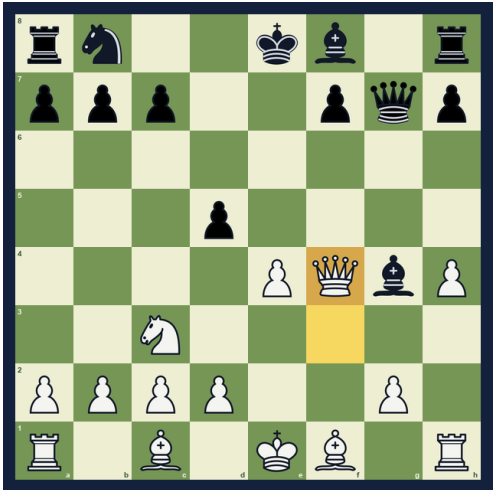
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

10. Kieseritzky Main Battle - Stage 5



KGA KIESERITZKY

POSITION PROMPT

White meets Black's central counterplay with Nc3 and Qf3, then recovers f4 without weakening the e-pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4 5. Ne5 Nf6 6. Nxc4 d5 7. Nxf6+ Qxf6 8. Nc3 Qg7 9. Qf3 Bg4 10. Qxf4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

11. Classical and Hanstein Development - Stage 1



KGA CLASSICAL

POSITION PROMPT

White develops the bishop actively instead of beginning with an immediate pawn-chain attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. Bc4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

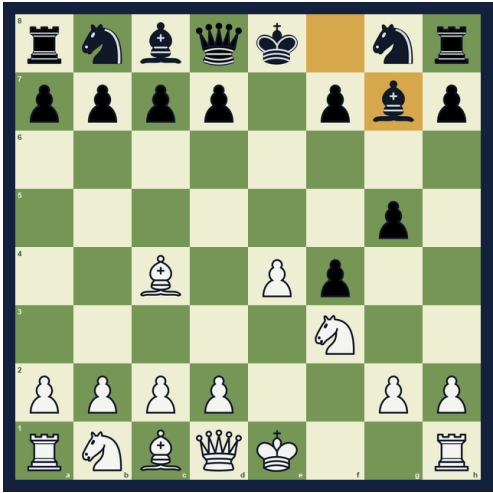
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

12. Classical and Hanstein Development - Stage 2



KGA CLASSICAL

POSITION PROMPT

Black has fianchettoed the bishop behind the extra kingside pawns.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. Bc4 Bg7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

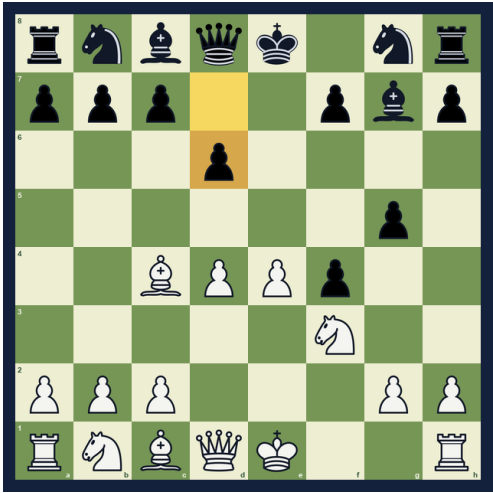
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

13. Classical and Hanstein Development - Stage 3



KGA CLASSICAL

POSITION PROMPT

White owns a strong d4-e4 center while Black prepares to consolidate.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. Bc4 Bg7 5. d4 d6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

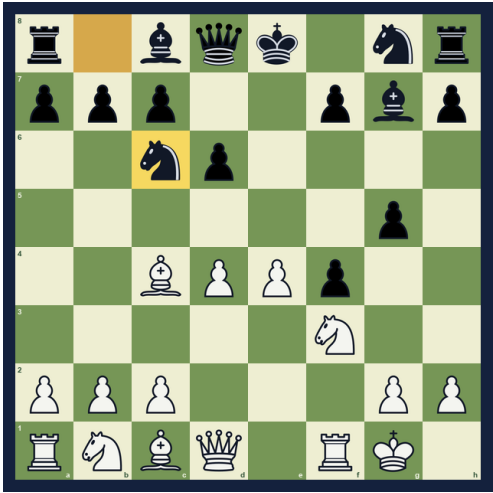
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

14. Classical and Hanstein Development - Stage 4



KGA CLASSICAL

POSITION PROMPT

White is castled and has converted development into real king safety and rook activity.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. Bc4 Bg7 5. d4 d6 6. O-O Nc6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

15. Classical and Hanstein Development - Stage 5



KGA CLASSICAL

POSITION PROMPT

The c3 support move stabilizes d4 and prepares development while Black gives the g5 chain support.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. Bc4 Bg7 5. d4 d6 6. O-O Nc6 7. c3 h6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

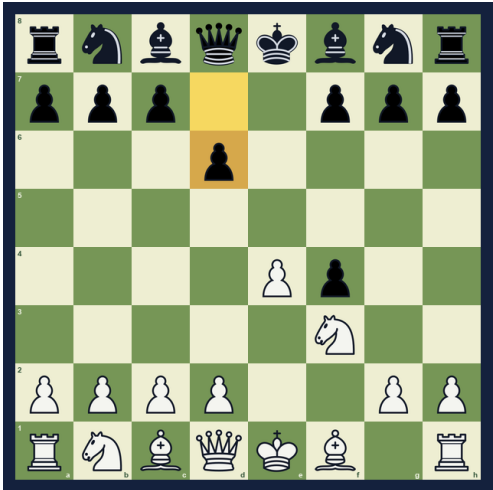
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

16. Fischer Defense - Stage 1



KGA FISCHER DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

Black uses ...d6 to control e5 before supporting the extra pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

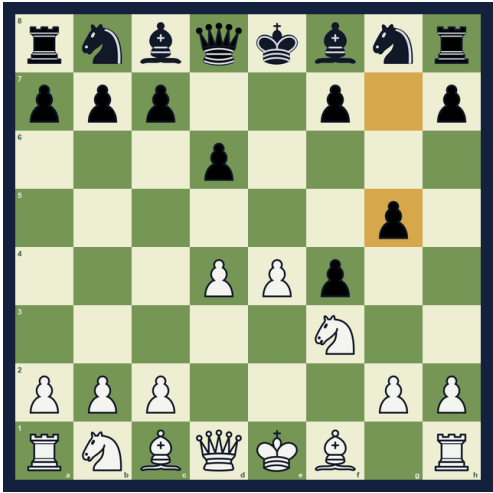
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

17. Fischer Defense - Stage 2



KGA FISCHER DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

White has built d4 while Black begins the familiar ...g5 defense.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d6 4. d4 g5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

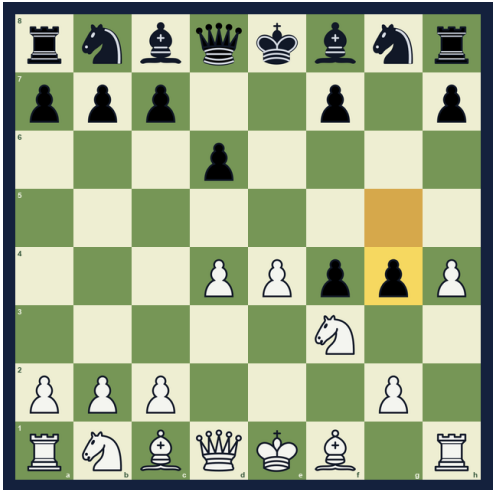
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

18. Fischer Defense - Stage 3



KGA FISCHER DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

The knight is attacked by ...g4, but Black's center is less flexible because of ...d6.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d6 4. d4 g5 5. h4 g4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

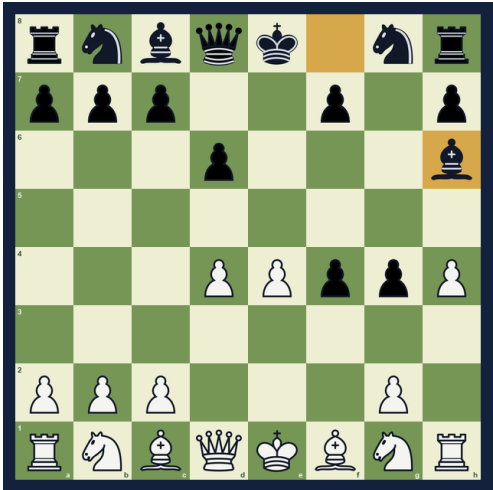
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

19. Fischer Defense - Stage 4



KGA FISCHER DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

White has accepted a retreat to g1 while Black's bishop develops actively to h6.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d6 4. d4 g5 5. h4 g4 6. Ng1 Bh6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

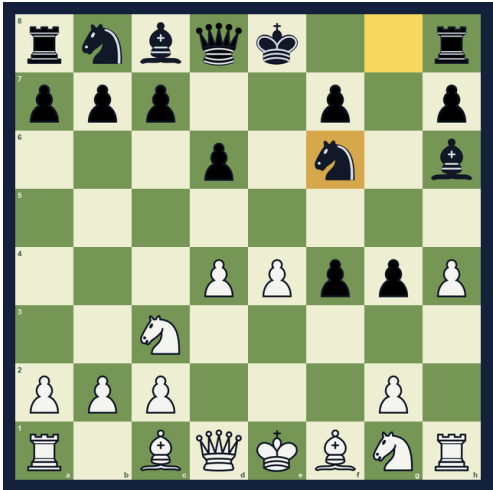
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

20. Fischer Defense - Stage 5



KGA FISCHER DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

White continues with development rather than forcing an unsound pawn recovery.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d6 4. d4 g5 5. h4 g4 6. Ng1 Bh6 7. Nc3 Nf6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

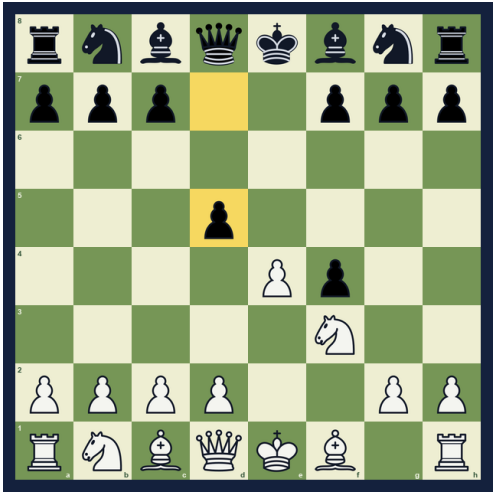
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

21. Modern Defense with ...d5 - Stage 1



KGA MODERN DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

Black immediately attacks White's center with ...d5 instead of protecting f4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

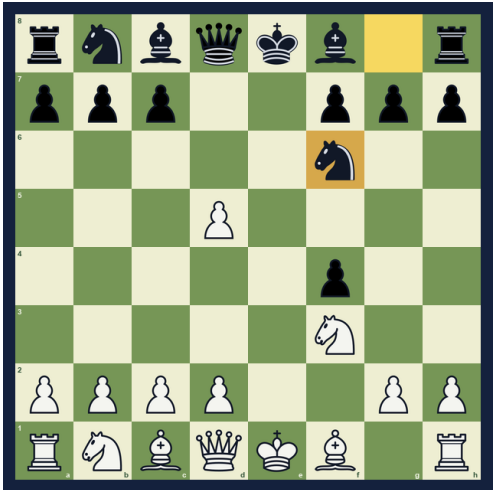
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

22. Modern Defense with ...d5 - Stage 2



KGA MODERN DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

White has exchanged on d5 while Black develops with tempo against the advanced pawn.

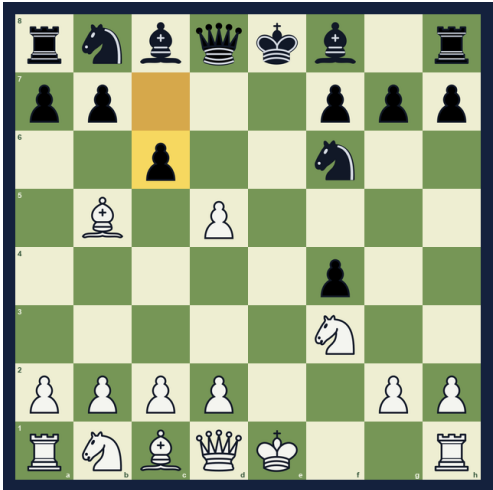
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 Nf6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

23. Modern Defense with ...d5 - Stage 3



KGA MODERN DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

Bb5 check forces Black to solve development and central pressure concretely.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 Nf6 5. Bb5+ c6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

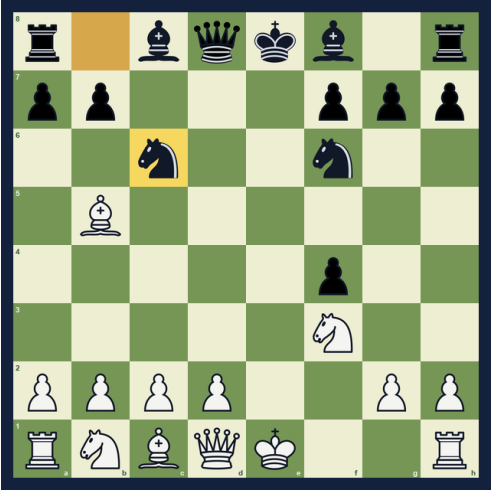
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

24. Modern Defense with ...d5 - Stage 4



KGA MODERN DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

Central exchanges have activated Black's knight but also opened lines for White's pieces.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 Nf6 5. Bb5+ c6 6. dxc6 Nxc6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

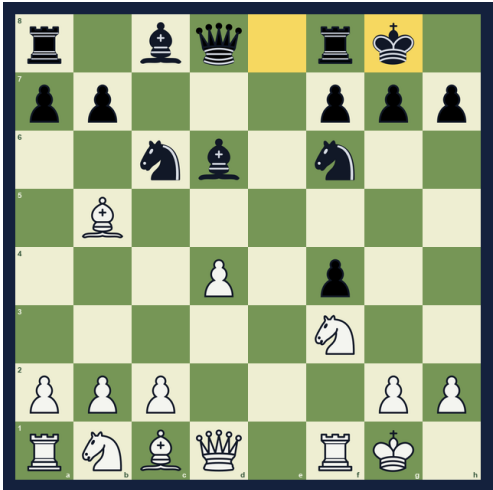
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

25. Modern Defense with ...d5 - Stage 5



KGA MODERN DEFENSE

POSITION PROMPT

Both sides are castled in an open position where development outweighs the original pawn sacrifice.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 Nf6 5. Bb5+ c6 6. dxc6 Nxc6 7. d4 Bd6 8. O-O O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

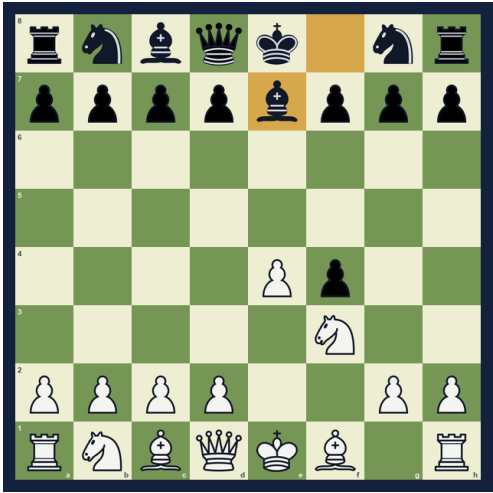
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

26. Cunningham Defense - Stage 1



KGA CUNNINGHAM

POSITION PROMPT

Black develops ...Be7 and prepares a disruptive check on h4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Be7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

27. Cunningham Defense - Stage 2



KGA CUNNINGHAM

POSITION PROMPT

The bishop has reached h4 with check, forcing White to solve king safety immediately.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Be7 4. Bc4 Bh4+

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

28. Cunningham Defense - Stage 3



KGA CUNNINGHAM

POSITION PROMPT

White's king has moved to f1, losing castling rights but keeping the center intact.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Be7 4. Bc4 Bh4+ 5. Kf1 d6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

29. Cunningham Defense - Stage 4



KGA CUNNINGHAM

POSITION PROMPT

White builds d4 while Black begins to reinforce the extra f4 pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Be7 4. Bc4 Bh4+ 5. Kf1 d6 6. d4 g5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

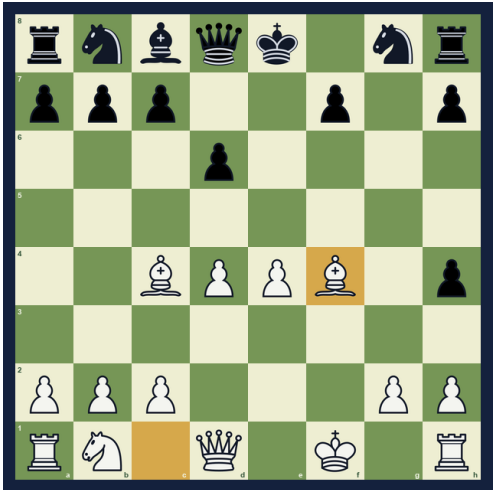
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

30. Cunningham Defense - Stage 5



KGA CUNNINGHAM

POSITION PROMPT

A forcing exchange has opened lines and allowed White's c1-bishop to recover the f4 pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Be7 4. Bc4 Bh4+ 5. Kf1 d6 6. d4 g5 7. Nxh4 gxh4 8. Bxf4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

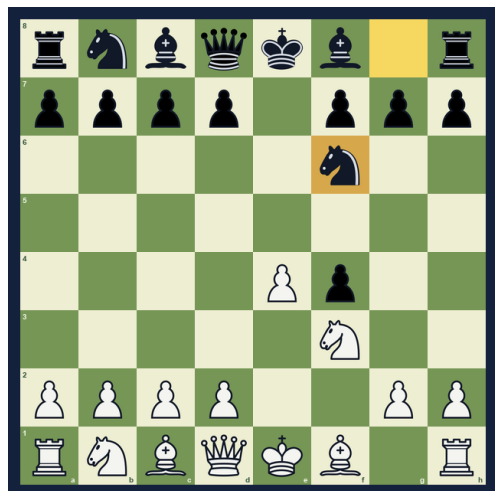
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

31. Schallop Defense - Stage 1



KGA SCHALLOPP

POSITION PROMPT

Black develops ...Nf6 immediately and attacks e4 rather than supporting f4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Nf6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- ### 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

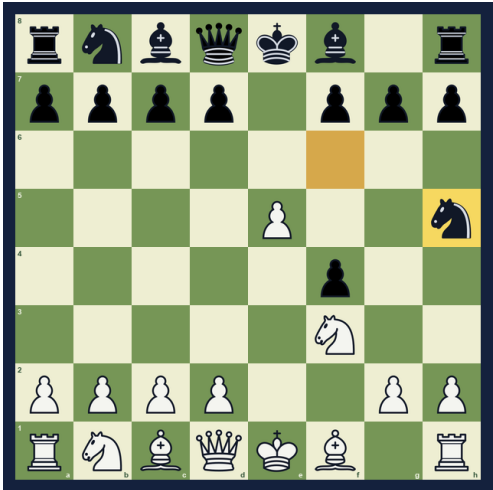
4. Which piece has the least useful job?

.....

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

32. Schallop Defense - Stage 2



KGA SCHALLOPP

POSITION PROMPT

White has gained space with e5 and driven the knight to h5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e5 Nh5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

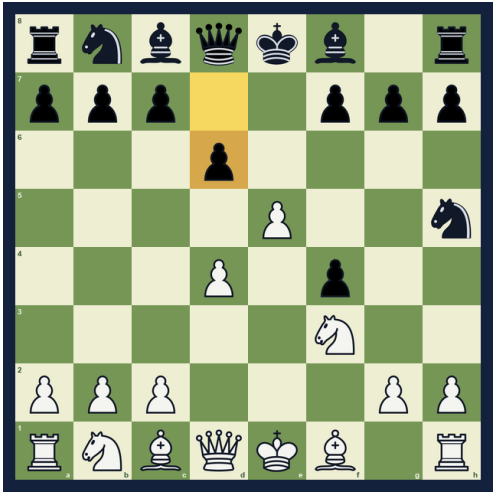
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

33. Schallop Defense - Stage 3



KGA SCHALLOPP

POSITION PROMPT

White supports the center with d4 while Black challenges it with ...d6.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e5 Nh5 5. d4 d6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

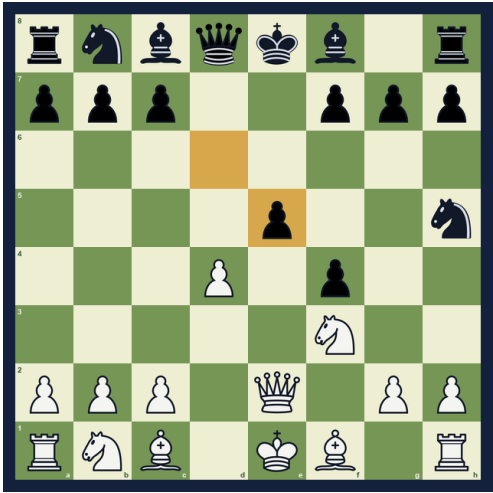
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

34. Schallop Defense - Stage 4



KGA SCHALLOPP

POSITION PROMPT

The queen supports e5 as central captures begin.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e5 Nh5 5. d4 d6 6. Qe2 dxe5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

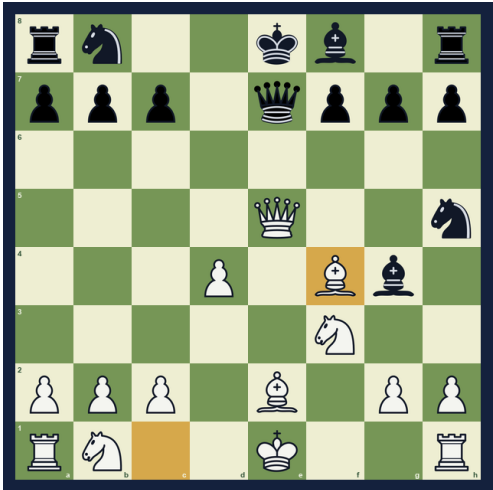
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

35. Schallop Defense - Stage 5



KGA SCHALLOPP

POSITION PROMPT

Black has accurately blocked the check with ...Qe7; White develops and recovers f4 while accepting a possible bishop-for-knight trade.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e5 Nh5 5. d4 d6 6. Qe2 dxe5 7. Qxe5+ Qe7 8. Be2 Bg4 9. Bxf4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

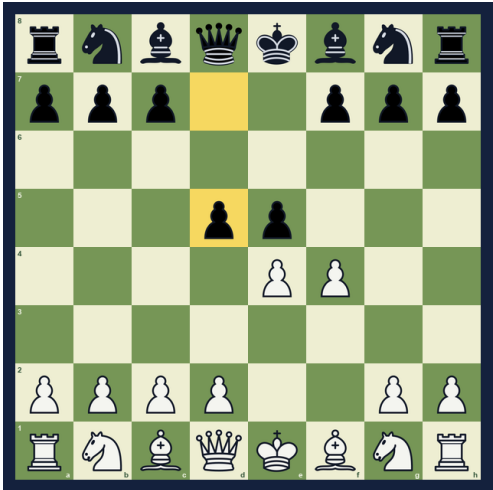
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

36. Falkbeer Countergambit - Stage 1



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

Black declines the gambit pawn and counterattacks the center with ...d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 d5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

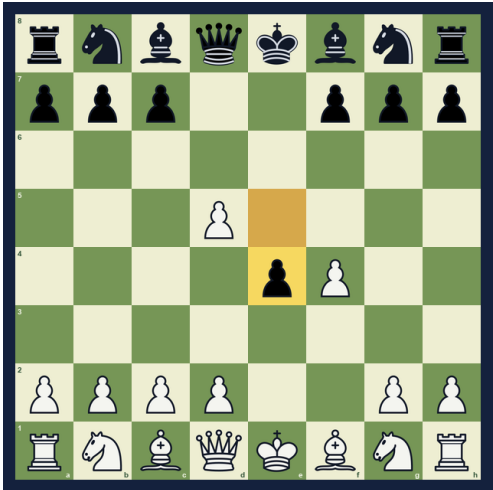
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

37. Falkbeer Countergambit - Stage 2



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

White has captured d5 while Black advances e4 and attacks White's development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 d5 3. exd5 e4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

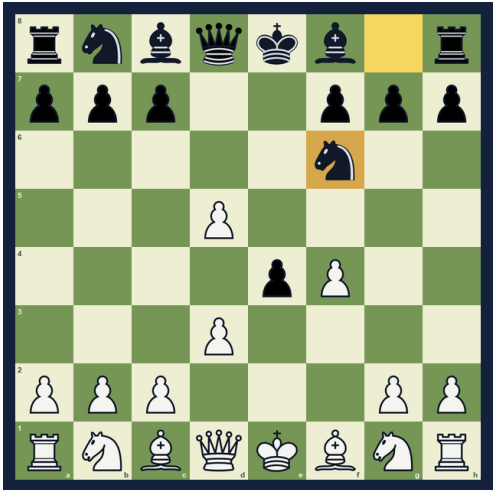
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

38. Falkbeer Countergambit - Stage 3



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

White challenges the e4 wedge with d3 while Black develops with tempo.

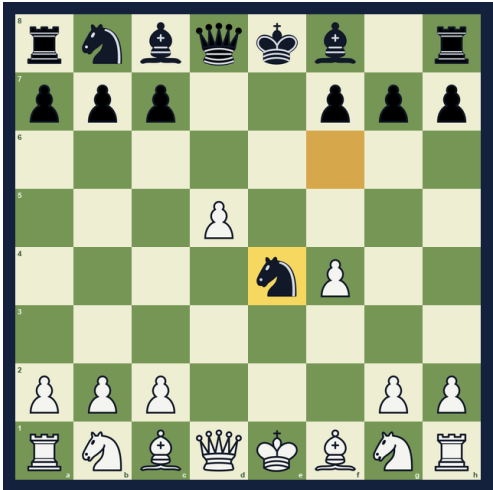
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 d5 3. exd5 e4 4. d3 Nf6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

39. Falkbeer Countergambit - Stage 4



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

Central exchanges have brought Black's knight to e4 in an open position.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 d5 3. exd5 e4 4. d3 Nf6 5. dxe4 Nxe4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

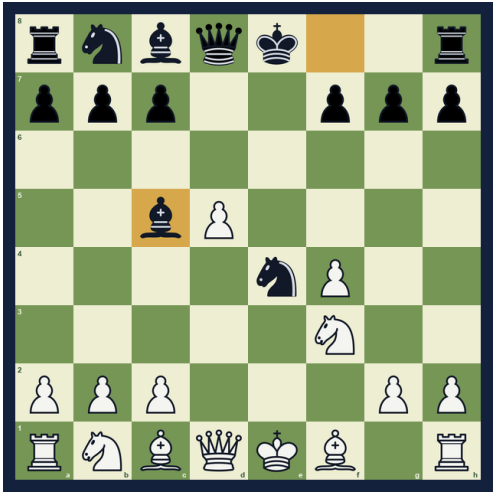
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

40. Falkbeer Countergambit - Stage 5



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

White has developed Nf3 while Black places the bishop actively on c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 d5 3. exd5 e4 4. d3 Nf6 5. dxe4 Nxe4 6. Nf3 Bc5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

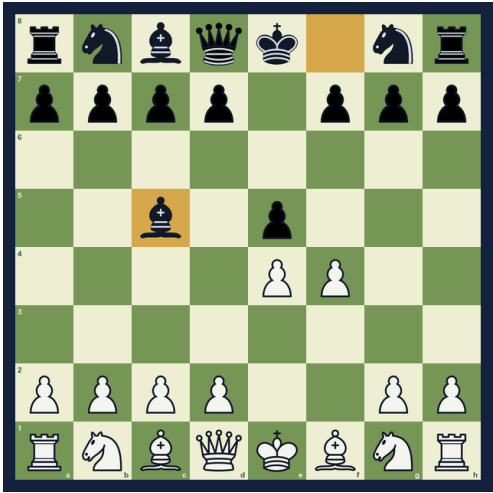
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

41. King's Gambit Declined - Stage 1



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

Black declines the pawn and develops the bishop actively to c5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 Bc5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

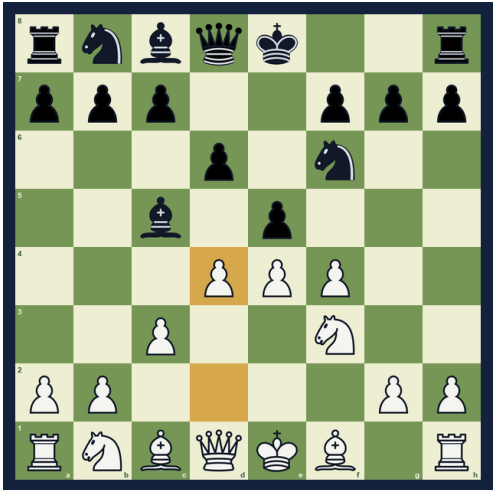
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

42. King's Gambit Declined - Stage 2



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

White prepares and plays d4 to challenge Black's central point.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 Bc5 3. Nf3 d6 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

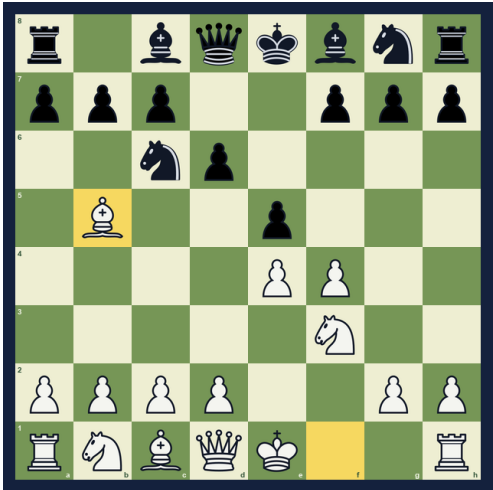
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

43. King's Gambit Declined - Stage 3



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

Black uses a compact ...d6 and ...Nc6 setup while White pins the knight.

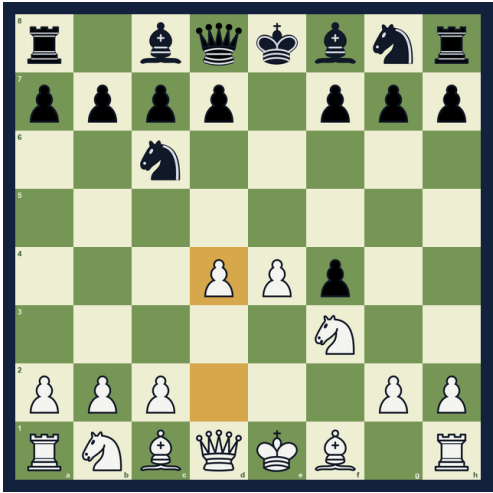
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 d6 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. Bb5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

44. King's Gambit Declined - Stage 4



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

Black delays acceptance until development has changed the circumstances.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 Nc6 3. Nf3 exf4 4. d4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

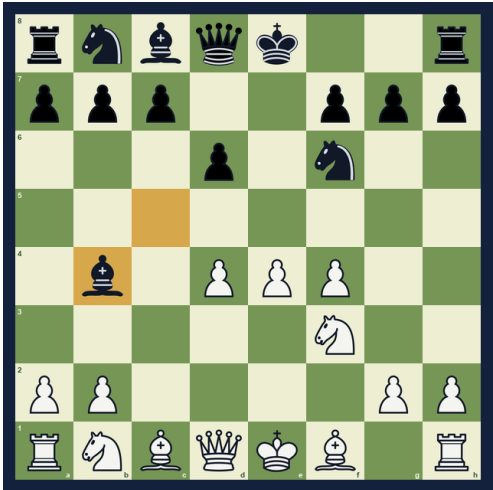
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

45. King's Gambit Declined - Stage 5



KING'S GAMBIT DECLINED

POSITION PROMPT

Central exchanges have created an open position with an active bishop check on b4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 Bc5 3. Nf3 d6 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. cxd4 Bb4+

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

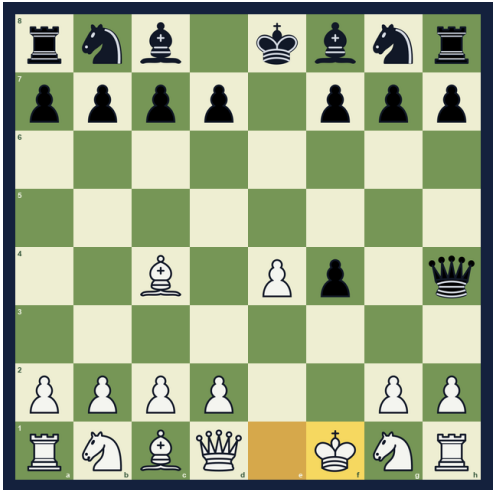
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

46. Historical Sacrifices and Safety - Stage 1



SHARP SIDELINES

POSITION PROMPT

The Bishop's Gambit allows ...Qh4 check and accepts an exposed king for rapid development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Bc4 Qh4+ 4. Kf1

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

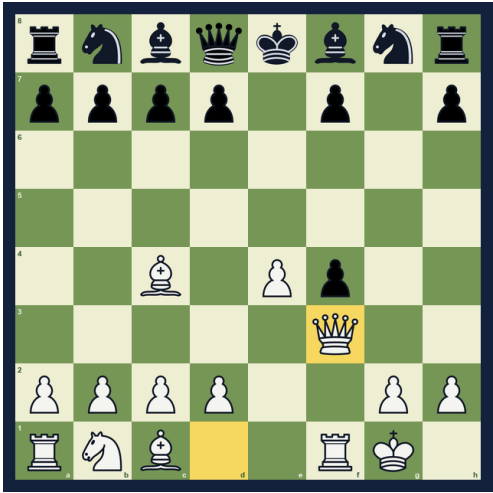
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

47. Historical Sacrifices and Safety - Stage 2



SHARP SIDELINES

POSITION PROMPT

The Muzio has sacrificed a knight for development and direct lines against Black's king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. Bc4 g4 5. O-O gxf3 6. Qxf3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

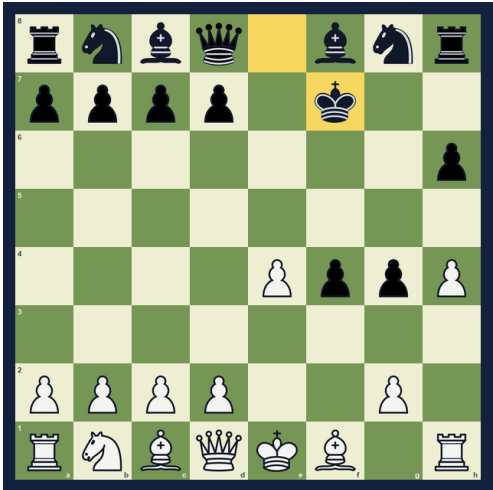
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

48. Historical Sacrifices and Safety - Stage 3



SHARP SIDELINES

POSITION PROMPT

The Allgaier sacrifice has drawn Black's king to f7 at substantial material cost.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. h4 g4 5. Ng5 h6 6. Nxf7 Kxf7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

49. Historical Sacrifices and Safety - Stage 4



SHARP SIDELINES

POSITION PROMPT

The Quaade develops Nc3 and keeps several attacking choices without sacrificing immediately.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Nf3 g5 4. Nc3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

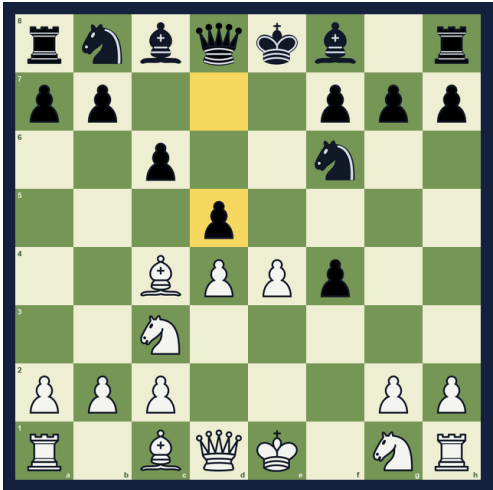
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

50. Historical Sacrifices and Safety - Stage 5



SHARP SIDELINES

POSITION PROMPT

A developed Bishop's Gambit has reached a central confrontation instead of an automatic mating attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. f4 exf4 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Nc3 c6 5. d4 d5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.